

Onboarding Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy outlines the process, formalities, and support provided to new employees joining TCS to ensure a smooth transition into the organization.

2. Scope

Applies to all new full-time, part-time, and contract employees joining any TCS location.

3. Definitions

Day 0	The employee's official first day of joining.
Employee Portal	TCS's self-service HR and IT platform, portal.tcs-internal.com .
Buddy	A peer assigned to help a new joiner settle in during their first month.

4. Joining Formalities

New employees complete joining formalities on Day 0 at their base office location (or virtually, for remote hires) via the HR Induction Desk. This includes signature of the employment agreement, submission of required documents, biometric registration, and issuance of the Employee ID.

5. Required Documents

New joiners must submit the following documents during onboarding, either in advance via the portal or physically on Day 0:

- Government-issued photo ID (Aadhaar, Passport, or Voter ID).
- PAN card.
- Educational certificates (highest qualification and any relevant degrees).
- Relieving letter and last 3 months' payslips from previous employer (if applicable).
- Bank account details for salary processing (cancelled cheque or passbook copy).
- Passport-size photographs (2).
- Address proof (utility bill, rental agreement, or Aadhaar).

Original documents are verified once and returned the same day; the HR team retains self-attested photocopies for records, per the Cyber Security Policy's confidentiality requirements (TCS-HR-008).

6. Employee ID Creation

A unique Employee ID (format: TCS-XXXXXX) is generated on Day 0 and used for all HR, payroll, and system access purposes throughout the employee's tenure. The physical ID card, which doubles as building access, is issued within the first 2 working days.

7. IT Account Creation

IT accounts, including company email, VPN credentials, and access to core systems (Slack, Zoom, employee portal, and project-specific tools), are provisioned before Day 0 based on the offer letter and role, and activated on the employee's first login on Day 0. See the Password and Access Control Policy (TCS-HR-010) for password setup requirements.

8. Laptop Allocation

A company-standard laptop is allocated to every new employee and handed over on Day 0 at the base location, or shipped in advance for remote/virtual joiners with tracked delivery confirmation required at least 1 day before joining. Full terms of use are covered in the Laptop and IT Equipment Policy (TCS-HR-007).

9. Orientation

New employees attend a 2-day company orientation program covering company history, organizational structure, values and culture, benefits overview, and mandatory compliance training (POSH, Code of Conduct, and Information Security awareness). Orientation is conducted every Monday for that week's new joiners.

10. HR Induction

During HR Induction, new joiners are walked through the Employee Handbook (TCS-HR-001), Leave Policy (TCS-HR-002), Benefits enrollment, and payroll setup. Employees are also introduced to their HRBP and assigned a workplace 'Buddy' to help them settle in during the first month.

11. Training

Role-specific technical training begins in the first week, coordinated by the Reporting Manager and the Learning & Development team. Mandatory compliance modules (data security, anti-harassment, code of conduct) must be completed within the first 15 days via the e-learning platform, per the Training and Learning Policy (TCS-HR-013).

12. First-Week Activities

In the first week, new employees are expected to: complete all mandatory e-learning modules; meet their Buddy and immediate team; set up their workstation and verify VPN/system access; review and acknowledge key policies on the employee portal; and schedule a 1:1 with their Reporting Manager to align on goals for the probation period.

13. Probation Information

New employees are on probation for 6 months from Day 0, as detailed in the Employee Handbook (TCS-HR-001, Section 6). During this period, employees are generally not eligible for routine Work From Home (see Work From Home Policy, TCS-HR-004) except for approved Emergency WFH, and accrue a reduced Casual Leave balance. Formal check-ins occur at 3 and 5 months, leading to confirmation of employment.

14. Employee Portal Usage

The employee portal (portal.tcs-internal.com) is the central hub for attendance, leave, payslips, benefits enrollment, IT support tickets, and policy documents. New employees receive portal login credentials along with their IT account and are encouraged to explore the 'New Joiner' dashboard, which consolidates all pending onboarding tasks.

15. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What documents are required during onboarding?

A: Government photo ID, PAN card, educational certificates, relieving letter and payslips from the previous employer, bank details, photographs, and address proof.

Q: What happens during employee induction?

A: New employees are introduced to the Employee Handbook, Leave Policy, benefits enrollment, payroll setup, their HRBP, and are assigned a workplace Buddy for their first month.

Q: Can I work from home while I am on probation?

A: Routine WFH is generally not available during the 6-month probation period, though Emergency WFH can be approved case-by-case; see the Work From Home Policy (TCS-HR-004).

Q: Where can I find my employee policies?

A: All onboarding and HR documents are available on the employee portal under the 'New Joiner' dashboard and Policies section.

16. Contact Information

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